The Bible: The Complete Word of God (Abridged)

By Adam Long, Reed Martin and Austin Tichenor

NOTE from the Authors: Written for 3 characters (Austin, Matt and Reed) However, each cast member should use his/her own real name when performing the show. We encourage each production to change the topical references in the script to keep them as up-to-date as possible.

Suggested Roles: ***Actor 1:*** *Adam, Austin, Matt-1(shared role)*
Actor 2: *Voice Over, Eve, Reed, Matt-2 (shared role)*

NOTE: This cutting asks each student to portray multiple characters, which is permissible for Nationals and SOME states. It may not meet the rules requirement for DUO in your state! Be sure to check your STATE rules before performing at local tournaments.

VOICE OVER: (Pg 1-2) *(off stage)* In the beginning, there was . . . chaos. Everything was void.

God saw all that emptiness . . . *(hums a song rising to a crescendo and crash)* Let there be light!

Adam stands aghast in the fig leaf position, covering his significant body part – music rises again to a crash – Both actors stand aghast as Adam and Eve, covering their significant body parts.

INTRODUCTION

ACTOR 1: *Hello, I'm _____*
ACTOR 2: *I'm _____*
ACTOR 1: *. . . and welcome to the _____Speech Tournament and today's performance of The Bible: The Complete Word of God (abridged) by Adam Long, Reed Martin and Austin Tichenor*

REED: (Pg 4-6) We'll be taking you on a marvelous, spiritual journey. A quest, if you will.

AUSTIN: A journey towards enlightenment! We present to you, The Bible – the Greatest Story Ever Accepted as Fact.

MATT-2: And we'll explain it all -- Make the unknown known.

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AUSTIN: The inexplicable plicable.

REED: It's important to point out that although this show is about the Bible, it is not about any particular religion.

AUSTIN: That's right. It is not our intention to slander Christians, or Jews, or Muslims . . .

MATT-2: Or Buddists or Druids or agnostics . . .

AUSTIN: Or Catholics or cult members of any kind. It's not what we want to do . . .

REED: No, why would you . . . I have done extensive research on *(holds up a book)* The King James Edition of the Holy Bible. *(he tosses the Bible to Austin and exits)*

AUSTIN: (Pg 8-9) *(reading from the great book)* And the Lord God caused a deep sleep to fall upon Adam, and he slept *(Reed pantomimes as Austin speaks)* And God took one of Adam's ribs and made he a woman, and brought her unto the Man.

REED: *(enters as Eve)* Good morning! *(takes a bite of an apple and tosses it to Austin)* Let the downfall of Man begin! Nyah-ha-ha!!

AUSTIN: *(takes a bite of the apple and continues reading with his mouth full)* And God looked down on Adam and Eve and knew they had eaten of the forbidden fruit. *(tosses apple way with a horrified look on his face)* **(Pg 10)** This brings us to Chapter Five of Genesis – The Genealogy of Adam.

REED: (Pg 12-13) *(rapping)* . . . Begattin', begattin' / Everywhere begattin' /

AUSTIN: Makin' babies happen / 'Cause back then there was nothing else to do!

*****Scene change****

REED: *(Holding aloft a replica of the Ark)* The Ark. Noah's Ark. What I have here in my hands is an exact replica of Noah's Ark that I have personally carved over the last nine years out of genuine gopherwood I imported from the Middle East.

AUSTIN: *(applauding over the last few words and a bit of patronizing)* Wow! Good Job! *(Yawn)* So . . . let's move on!

REED: What about Noah's Ark?

AUSTIN: We just did it.

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REED: We didn't DO Noah's Ark. We introduced Noah's Ark. But we didn't DO Noah's Ark. *(Austin rolls his eyes)* **(Pg 14)** There's a lot of unanswered questions about Noah's Ark . . .

AUSTIN: Like what?

REED: Were there dinosaurs on the Ark?

AUSTIN: *(frustrated)* Yes!

REED: They're not mentioned in the Bible

AUSTIN: There's a lot of things not mentioned in the Bible. Handguns . . . telephones . . . computers . . .

MATT-2: Wait a minute! Computers were on Noah's Ark?

AUSTIN: No. Don't be silly. Computers were in the Garden of Eden.

REED: Ohhhh . . . yeah . . . Eve had an Apple. *(To Audience – back to his Ark)* Now if you look very closely, I think you can see . .

MATT-1: Stop it, Reed, you're boring everybody.

REED: *(taking offense)* No, I'm not.

MATT-1: Yes, you are. The story of Noah's Ark is sooooo overdone. Everybody knows it, and besides, it probably never happened.

REED: **(Pg 15)** *(shocked)* Never happened?!? Never happened?!? Why, they might as well say that the whole Bible never happened! What do they think is up there on Mount Ararat, anyway – The titanic? They might as well strip me of my childlike faith and innocence. They might as well mock *(insert name of Actor 1)* because he's never kissed anyone! They might as well tell all of you that I still wet the bed!

AUSTIN: You still wet the bed? Eeeuwwww!

REED: Stop listening to my inner monologue! **(Pg 24)** Now we move on the book of Exodus, where we join Moses . . .

AUSTIN: **(Pg 25-26)** *(as Moses)* All right, listen up, children of Israel. I've got some good news and some bad news. The good news is, I got Him down to ten. *(response)* The bad news is, adultery is still one of 'em. *(response)* As for the commandments I talked God out of . . . Number 1: Seventies fashions were ugly then and they're ugly now!

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Number 2: Thou shalt let the poor fend for themselves. Oh, sorry. No, that's the Republican agenda.

Number 3: *Stuff* happens

Number 4: *(From the Appendix)* Thou shalt not "SHOW ME THE MONEY!" and . . .

Number 5: The English shalt not give back Northern Ireland until the Irish take back "Riverdance"! *(they both do their rendition of Riverdancing)* G'night, everybody!

MATT-2: And there was great rejoicing and great balls of fire. And in his hundred and twentieth year, Moses did die.

*****Scene*****

AUSTIN: **(Pg 46)** You ready? The Wise Men!

MATT-2: **(Pg 47)** *(looking to the heavens)* Of all the nights for the Middle East to be overcast.

AUSTIN: We better hurry, or we won't be there in time for Christmas. He's gonna love what I got him.

MATT-2: I don't know, mine's pretty valuable.

AUSTIN: I'll show you mine, you show me yours. One, two, three! *(they show their gifts)*

TOGETHER: Baseball mitts!

MATT-2: **(Pg 48)** I thought you were getting him gold.

AUSTIN: I thought you were getting him frankincense. *(both shrug)*

MATT-2: **(Pg 49)** Look! A shooting star! The sky's cleared up! Let's go!

AUSTIN: Wait, I'm confused. What are we supposed to do when we get there?

REED: We worship the Christ child and then we give him his birthday presents.

MATT-1: Wow – his birthday falls on Christmas? Tough break!

REED: Follow me! *(they arrive at the stable)*

MATT-2: **(Pg 51)** *(as Mary)* Joseph, it's time!

AUSTIN: *(as Joseph)* Oh, my gosh! Quick towels and hot water! *(he holds the screaming baby aloft)*

MATT-2: *(as Mary)* We will name him Jesus!

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TOGETHER: *(singing as the wisemen)* We wish you a merry Christmas! We wish you a merry Christmas! We wish you a merry Christmas! Our dear son of God! . . . . For he's a jolly good savior, For he's a jolly good savior, For he's a jolly good savior – Who Peter will deny!

*******Scene*******

AUSTIN: **(Pg 56-57)** *(as Joseph – waving a piece of paper)* Mary, Mary! Look what I found in my carpentry shop! It's a note from Jesus.

MATT-2: *(as Mary)* Oh, dear . . . *(reading)* "Dear Mother and Fa . . . Joseph . . ." Sorry, honey.

AUSTIN: That sucks!

MATT-2: He loves you.

AUSTIN: *(sulking)* He loves everybody! Read the note. . . *(freeze for the voice over)*

VOICE OVER: "Dear Mother and Joseph, I just don't feel I have what it takes to be a good carpenter. So I'm leaving to wander in the wilderness for forty days and forty nights to, well, get my head together. Don't worry, I'll be fine. Love, your miracle, Jesus."

MATT-2: Can you earn a living as a Messiah?

AUSTIN: No, that's why I wanted him to go into his father's business.

MATT-2: He is.

AUSTIN: No, my business!

*******Scene*******

AUSTIN: **(Pg 69-71)** And now, as we race through the last half of the New Testament, we are proud to present to you the adult life of Jesus! Jesus raises Lazarus from the dead! *(Reed pantomimes a Zombie walk)* Jesus feeds the multitudes with bread and fishes!

REED: *(throws fish to the audience)* [And you get a fish . . . and you get a fish . . . Everyone gets a fish!]

AUSTIN: Jesus performs miracles! *(Reed makes loops with his thumbs and forefingers like an OK sign. He puts them behind his head and when he reveals them, they are intertwined. He puts them behind his head again and then reveals they are no longer connected)* **(Pg 74-75)** Jesus is crucified! *(realizes he's said this with too much enthusiasm, he tries again with sadness)* Jesus is crucified.

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REED: Crucified . . .

AUSTIN: *(Very, very simply)* And the soldiers led Jesus away and forced a crown of thorns onto His head. They crucified him, and a great darkness fell over the land. Then came the most beautiful aspect of the entire New Testament . . . Jesus is resurrected! *(They both rejoice)*

*******Scene*******

AUSTIN: **(Pg 76-77)** Now we have a very special treat for you. As you know, there are so many great musicals based on the Bible. You know, like Jesus Christ Superstar . . . *(struggling to name another)* Oklahoma! So in the spirit of those musicals, we'd like to present to you, the final book of the Bible in a little something that we like to call . . . REVELATION --

TOGETHER: THE MUSICAL!

REED: *(Singing and both dancing)* Oh, the saved are surrounded with love / And removed to the heavens above / And the damned are in a bit of a jam

TOGETHER: That's Armageddon!

AUSTIN: *(Singing and both dancing)* Oh, the bad know they've made a mistake / They are cast into a fiery lake / It's a goof, unless they are fireproof

TOGETHER: That's Armageddon! *(Austin continues to hum and dance weirdly by himself while Reed speaks to the audience)*

REED: **(Pg 78-79)** Yes, Armageddon – the end of the world. And with the end of the world comes the end of our little trip through the Bible . . .

TOGETHER: Aaahhhhhh – men!!

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SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

National Qualifier Prior to 2001
2004 National Qualifier
2007 National Qualifier
2008 National Qualifier
2009 National Qualifier
2010 National Qualifier
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2014 National Qualifier
2019 National Qualifier
2021 National Qualifier

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